

Advantages

That's an obvious question for users who are not much into flashing their devices and hence, run the risk of bricking it. The answer is quite simple- exploring your phone to maximum possibilities. Flashing is basically 'replacing' your firmware files with those which have better utilisation of your phone's resources. This gives following important advantages

- ▶ **Increase your phone memory** – The most common problem on Symbian Belle devices today, especially Nokia N8, is its low phone memory. Though, unlike Android, you can install your apps on memory card, but the browser cache, i.e. every time you use your default browser, it stores browsing information on phone memory and some data files from apps and games that you install on your phone, hogs up your internal memory. This in turn makes your phone slow. Flashing is a good way to free up all device memory and make it faster and smoother. Also, mods (modifications) are available through which we can change the browser cache memory to external memory card and thereby save space.
- ▶ **Theme Effects** – Symbian has got wide range of theme effects, but unfortunately, not by default. A third party software named ThemeFX lets you change them with just a restart. But, you need to hack your phone to install that software. Another way to do this is flash your phone with a Customised Firmware (CFW). There are many available on net. The makers of these firmware have either preinstalled fancy effects or they let you choose your own. Theme effects are instantly noticed and appreciated when you or your friends use your phone. It certainly helps improve your phone's UI.
- ▶ **New widgets** – Symbian has got very limited number of widgets when compared to Android. Also, the customization options, i.e. skins, size etc of these widgets cannot be changed. But there are plenty of widgets outside the Nokia store which gives your phone a completely new look. These include widgets of clock, mail, RSS reader, weather and many more.
- ▶ **Startup sound and logo** – If you are tired of those Nokia hands you've been seeing from time immemorial, and are eager to get your own startup sound, then with hacking, that is easily possible. If you are planning on gifting a mobile to someone, personalizing startup sound of your phone will surely add spice to your gift.